Project Report: Digital Literacy

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INTRODUCTION:

This project serves as a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio, developed through the lens of a Student Digital Ambassador. The primary objective is to demonstrate proficiency in navigating the digital world, from professional profile creation to safe online communication. Over five modules, this report documents the creation of educational infographics, the establishment of a professional technical presence, coding practice, and research into cybersecurity threats. The ultimate goal is to provide a roadmap for peers to use digital tools responsibly and effectively in an academic and professional capacity.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

In this task, I created an infographic using Canva, which is a free and user-friendly design platform. The purpose of the infographic was to visually present important aspects of digital literacy in a simple and engaging way.

My design covered three main topics: the meaning of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students, and safe internet practices. I included brief definitions, examples of tools like online learning platforms, and key safety tips such as avoiding suspicious links and protecting personal information. I used icons, colors, and structured sections to make the infographic visually appealing and easy to understand.

While creating the design, I found it interesting to explore different templates and layouts available on Canva. It helped me understand how visual content can make information more attractive and easier to remember. However, one difficulty I faced was choosing the right layout and organizing the content without making it look crowded.

Overall, this task improved my creativity and helped me learn how to present information effectively using digital tools.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created and updated my profiles on HackerRank, Kaggle, and LinkedIn. Each of these platforms serves a different purpose in building technical and professional skills.

HackerRank is mainly used for practicing coding problems and improving problem-solving skills.Kaggle is focused on data science, where users can work with datasets, participate in competitions, and learn machine learning concepts. LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where I added my education details and started building my professional profile.

Setting up these platforms helped me understand their importance in career development. Over the next four years, I plan to regularly practice coding on HackerRank, explore datasets and participate in competitions on Kaggle, and actively update my LinkedIn profile with my achievements, projects, and skills.

This will help me build a strong portfolio, improve my technical knowledge, and connect with professionals in the industry, which will be beneficial for internships and job opportunities in the future.

Task 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

In this task, I used HackerRank to practice coding and improve my problem-solving skills. I completed a beginner-level challenge, which helped me understand basic programming logic and how to approach problems step by step. HackerRank provides a structured way to learn coding, and solving even simple problems helped me build confidence.

In addition to coding practice, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The form included multiple-choice and short-answer questions related to online safety and digital awareness. I also explored how responses are automatically recorded in Google Sheets, which makes data collection and analysis easier.

This task helped me understand both technical practice and collaborative tools. HackerRank will help me improve my coding skills regularly, which is important for exams and placements. Google Forms will be useful for academic surveys, feedback collection, and project work.

Overall, these tools will support my learning by improving both my technical abilities and my ability to create and manage digital content efficiently.

Task 4: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

In this task, I learned the importance of proper digital communication through email writing and social media usage. A common situation where poor digital communication can cause problems is when a student sends an informal or unclear email to a professor, such as not mentioning the subject properly or using casual language like "Hey" or incomplete sentences. This can create a negative impression and may result in the request being ignored or misunderstood.

For example, if a student asks for an assignment extension without explaining the reason clearly or politely, the professor may not consider the request seriously. This shows how important clarity, tone, and structure are in professional communication.

To avoid such issues, one should use a proper subject line, respectful greeting, clear explanation, and polite closing. Being professional and precise can make communication more effective and create a positive impression.

Task 5: Cybercrime Case Study & Prevention

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is a rapidly increasing cybercrime in India, where attackers trick users into transferring money through digital payment apps. This type of fraud mainly relies on social engineering and lack of user awareness.

A common scenario begins when a victim receives a phone call or message from someone pretending to be a bank official, customer support agent, or even a buyer from an online marketplace. The fraudster creates urgency by saying there is an issue with the bank account or a payment is pending. Next, the victim is asked to approve a "collect request" on their UPI app or scan a QR code. In some cases, they are also asked to share sensitive information like OTP or UPI PIN. Once the victim unknowingly approves the request, money is instantly transferred to the fraudster's account.

Students, elderly individuals, and people who are new to digital payments are usually targeted. The consequences include financial loss, stress, and difficulty in recovering the money due to the instant nature of transactions.

To prevent such fraud, users should never share OTPs or PINs, avoid clicking on unknown links, and carefully verify payment requests. Awareness and cautious behavior are essential to stay safe in the digital world.

Cybercrime Awareness Reflection

While researching cybercrime, what surprised me the most was how easily people fall victim to scams like UPI fraud. Many attacks do not require advanced hacking skills but instead rely on simple tricks such as fake calls, messages, or payment requests. It was surprising to see that even educated users can lose money due to a small mistake or lack of awareness.

I realized that cybercriminals mainly take advantage of urgency and trust to manipulate people. This made me understand that being careful is more important than just having technical knowledge.

One habit I will personally change is being more cautious while making online payments. I will always verify payment requests, avoid clicking on unknown links, and never share sensitive information like OTPs or UPI PINs. This awareness will help me stay safe in the digital environment.

Conclusion

This project has significantly enhanced my understanding of what it means to be digitally literate in a professional and academic environment. Beyond just using tools, I have learned the importance of maintaining a professional brand, communicating with integrity, and staying vigilant against online threats. As I move forward in my AI & ML career, these foundational digital skills will be as important as the code I write .

References

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HackerRank: hackerrank.com

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